Assignment 2 - Practical Exercise: Design a workflow diagram for handling IT service requests.

In this assignment, you will design a workflow diagram that visually represents how IT service requests are handled in an IT Helpdesk. A structured workflow ensures that requests are logged, categorized, prioritized, assigned, resolved, and documented efficiently.

Instructions

1. **Understand the IT Service Request Process**
    - Review the key steps involved in processing an IT service request, such as:
        - Ticket submission (user reports an issue).
        - Logging and categorization.
        - Prioritization and assignment.
        - Resolution, communication, and closure.
2. **Map Out the Workflow**
    - Create a **flowchart** that outlines each step in the process.
    - Use standard workflow symbols (e.g., rectangles for actions, diamonds for decisions).
    - Ensure your workflow includes:
        - **Entry points:** How users submit requests (email, portal, phone).
        - **Routing:** How tickets are categorized and assigned to the appropriate team.
        - **Resolution steps:** How issues are handled, including escalation if needed.
        - **Closure and feedback:** How users are informed once the issue is resolved.
3. **Use a Visualization Tool (Optional)**
    - You can create your workflow using tools such as:

- **Draw.io (diagrams.net)** – Free online tool for flowchart creation.
- **Microsoft Visio** – Advanced diagramming software.
- **Lucidchart** – Cloud-based diagramming tool.
- **Hand-drawn flowcharts** (if digital tools are not available).

4. **Submit Your Workflow Diagram**
    - Ensure the diagram is **clear, readable, and logically structured**.
    - Label all steps and decision points properly.
    - Save your diagram as a **PDF, PNG, or JPEG** file before submission.

Questions for this assignment

Grading Criteria

✅ **Completeness** – Workflow includes all necessary steps.
✅ **Clarity** – Diagram is well-structured, labeled, and easy to understand.
✅ **Logical Flow** – Steps follow a clear and efficient process.
✅ **Presentation** – Neat and professional design, with appropriate use of symbols.

Outcome

By completing this assignment, you will develop a **structured, visual representation** of the IT service request process. This will help you **streamline Helpdesk operations, reduce resolution time, and improve user experience**.

Solution by the Instructor:

Grading Criteria

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Solution Overview

The workflow diagram below represents a structured **IT service request process**, ensuring that all requests are **logged, categorized, prioritized, assigned, resolved, and documented efficiently**. This approach improves service delivery, reduces response time, and enhances user satisfaction.

Step-by-Step Breakdown of the IT Service Request Workflow

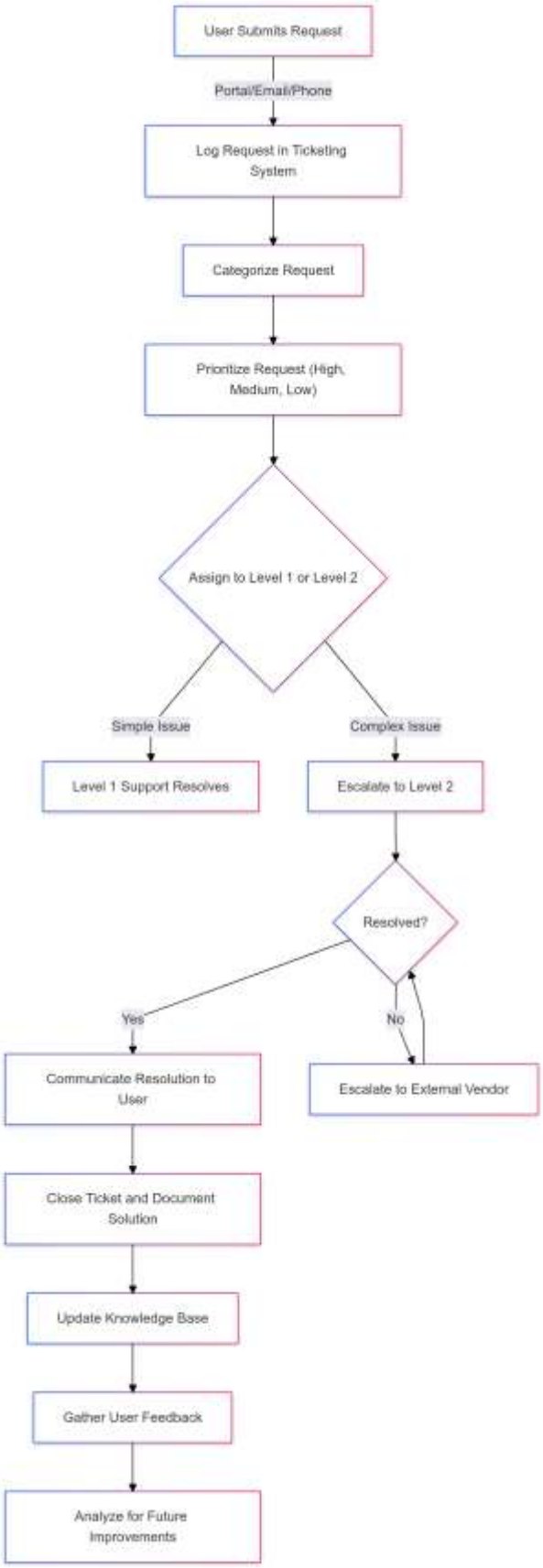
1. **User Submits a Service Request**
    - Users report issues through a **self-service portal, email, phone, or chat**.
    - The system logs the request automatically.
2. **Helpdesk Logs and Categorizes the Request**
    - A ticket is created in the **ticketing system** (e.g., Zendesk, Jira, Freshdesk).
    - The request is categorized (e.g., software, hardware, access request, network issue).
3. **Prioritize the Request**
    - Tickets are assigned a priority level:
        - **High Priority:** Business-critical systems down.
        - **Medium Priority:** Moderate impact on work.
        - **Low Priority:** Minor user inconvenience.
4. **Assign to the Appropriate Team**
    - **Level 1 Support** handles basic troubleshooting (e.g., password resets).
    - **Level 2 Support** manages complex issues (e.g., server access problems).
    - Tickets are **automatically routed** based on issue type and priority.
5. **Resolve the Request**
    - **Level 1 resolves** simple issues and updates the ticket.
    - If unresolved, **escalate to Level 2 or specialists**.

- If external vendor support is required, **coordinate with third-party providers**.

6. **Communicate Resolution to User**
    - Users receive an **update via email, portal, or phone** once the issue is fixed.
    - The ticketing system logs the resolution details for future reference.
7. **Close the Ticket**
    - Helpdesk verifies with the user that the issue is resolved.
    - The ticket is marked as **closed** in the system.
8. **Document the Solution**
    - Resolution steps are saved in the **knowledge base** for future reference.
    - Frequently occurring issues are analyzed for potential **automation or process improvements**.
9. **Gather User Feedback**
    - A **CSAT survey** (Customer Satisfaction) is sent to the user.
    - Feedback is reviewed for **continuous service improvement**.

Workflow Diagram (Solution)

Below is the **workflow diagram** illustrating the IT service request process.


User Submits Request
Portal/Email/Phone
Log Request in Ticketing System
Categorize Request
Prioritize Request (High, Medium, Low)
Assign to Level 1 or Level 2
Simple Issue
Complex Issue
Level 1 Support Resolves
Escalate to Level 2
Resolved?
Yes
No
Communicate Resolution to User
Escalate to External Vendor
Close Ticket and Document Solution
Update Knowledge Base
Gather User Feedback
Analyze for Future Improvements

Example Summary:

"This workflow ensures that IT service requests are processed in a structured and efficient manner. By categorizing and prioritizing requests, we can route them to the appropriate team, reducing resolution time. The inclusion of a feedback loop helps improve Helpdesk performance over time. Implementing this workflow enhances efficiency, improves customer satisfaction, and allows the Helpdesk to scale effectively as the organization grows."

Outcome

By completing this assignment, you will develop a **structured, visual representation of IT service request management**, enabling you to create a **scalable, data-driven, and user-centric Helpdesk operation**.